CURRICULUM VITAE

PATRICK KARANJA

Strategic Marketing, Communications & Digital Engagement Specialist

PROFILE

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Languages

- English
  Fluent read and write
- Swahili
  Fluent read and write

References

- Dr. Ehud Gachugu, PhD, HSC
  Deputy Chief Executive Officer & Global Director - Youth, Jobs & Ajira Digital

  Email: egachugu@kepsa.or.ke
- Mr. David Mwaura
  Head of Marketing Africa - Spiro

  Email: ngugid@gmail.com
- Mr. Sachil Gudka
  CEO - Graphic World Kenya

  Email: sachildp@gmail.com

Professional Summary

Marketing and communications professional with over 8 years of experience leading high-impact brand, communication, and digital engagement strategies across national development programs, private sector organizations, and technology-driven initiatives.

Specialized in designing and executing integrated communication campaigns that drive awareness, stakeholder engagement, program adoption, and measurable impact across youth employment, entrepreneurship, digital skills, innovation, and economic development sectors.

Extensive experience working with governments, development partners, international organizations, and private sector stakeholders including **Mastercard Foundation, Microsoft, GIZ, African Development Bank, Challenge Fund for Youth Employment, and leading industry associations.**

Recognized for transforming complex policy, workforce development, and digital economy initiatives into compelling narratives, strategic campaigns, and data-driven communication programs that engage youth, employers, investors, policymakers, and ecosystem partners.

Core expertise includes strategic communications, digital marketing, stakeholder engagement, content strategy, brand management, social media management, website content management, SEO-informed content development, visual storytelling, campaign analytics, thought leadership positioning, photography, videography, and creative direction.

Core Competencies

Strategic Communications

- Stakeholder Engagement
- Executive Communications
- Reputation Management
- Thought Leadership
- Public Affairs

Marketing & Brand Management

- Digital Marketing
- Integrated Campaigns
- Brand Management
- Content Strategy
- Social Media Management
- SEO & Analytics

Creative & Digital Tools

- Adobe Creative Suite
- Google Analytics
- Meta Business Suite
- Photography & Videography
- Motion Graphics
- AI Marketing Tools

Digital Platforms

- Social Media Management
- Email Marketing
- Website Management
- SEO Optimization

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Kenya Private Sector Alliance (KEPSA)
Nairobi, Kenya

Lead strategic marketing, communications, branding, and digital engagement initiatives for flagship national programs focused on youth employment, entrepreneurship, digital transformation, and AI skilling.

Responsible for developing and executing integrated communication strategies that strengthen stakeholder engagement, enhance program visibility, drive beneficiary participation, and support policy advocacy efforts across government, private sector, development partners, and youth ecosystems.

Key Programs Led:

- **Ajira Digital Program**
- **Kenya Youth Employment and Entrepreneurship Program (KYEEAP)**
- **Kenya AI Skilling Alliance (KAISA)**
- **Dual TVET programs**

Key Responsibilities

- Designed digital and print collateral including campaign identities, social media graphics, posters, infographics, presentations, reports, event materials and promotional assets.
- Translated programme information, employment data and technical messages into accessible infographics and visual stories for youth, government, development partners and private-sector audiences.
- Produced photography, video and multimedia content for programme activities, stakeholder engagements, campaigns, workshops and high-level events.
- Supported strategic communications campaigns reaching **1M+ digital impressions**, developing content aligned with programme objectives and audience needs.
- Developed communication materials for initiatives involving stakeholders including Mastercard Foundation, Ministry of ICT, private-sector partners and youth-focused programmes.
- Supported campaigns including International Youth Day, IWD/Diverse360, Ajira Digital communications, Ajira Diaries and weekly opportunity campaigns.
- Managed and produced content across digital channels, applying audience-focused messaging, visual consistency and platform-specific content approaches.

Strategic Achievements

Ajira Digital Program

Led communication and visibility initiatives for one of Kenya's most recognized youth employment programs, helping position digital work and online employment as viable pathways for economic participation among young people.

Developed integrated communication campaigns, impact storytelling frameworks, multimedia content strategies, and stakeholder engagement initiatives that strengthened program awareness among youth, employers, training institutions, government stakeholders, and development partners.

Kenya Youth Employment & Entrepreneurship Program (KYEEAP)

Directed communication efforts supporting a multi-stakeholder initiative focused on improving youth employability, entrepreneurship development, and private-sector job creation.

Translated complex program interventions, labour market insights, and entrepreneurship opportunities into accessible content that enhanced stakeholder understanding and beneficiary engagement.

Kenya AI Skilling Alliance (KAISA)

Supported the positioning of AI skills development and future workforce readiness through strategic communication initiatives, partner engagement campaigns, thought leadership content, and ecosystem storytelling.

Collaborated with global technology partners and ecosystem stakeholders to strengthen awareness around responsible AI adoption, digital skills development, and future-of-work opportunities.

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Swvl Kenya
(Digital Public Transport Company - Based Egypt/Dubai)
Nairobi, Kenya

Marketing Graphic Designer

Supported customer acquisition, market expansion, and brand growth initiatives for one of Africa's fastest-scaling mobility technology companies through performance-driven marketing design and digital campaign execution.

Key Contributions

- Designed and executed high-performing digital marketing assets supporting user acquisition and customer engagement initiatives.
- Collaborated with growth, product, marketing, and regional teams to localize campaigns across multiple markets.
- Developed conversion-focused advertising creatives for social, digital, mobile, and out-of-home channels. Strengthened customer experience through UX-informed design assets supporting app engagement and promotional campaigns.
- Contributed to rapid campaign deployment in a fast-growth startup environment while maintaining brand consistency.

Business Impact

- Enhanced campaign performance through data-informed creative optimization.
- Improved speed-to-market for customer acquisition campaigns.
- Strengthened brand visibility during a critical growth and expansion phase.

Socialmeds Digital Limited
(Digital Media Agency)
Nairobi, Kenya

Marketing Graphic Designer

Delivered integrated creative, digital marketing, and brand communication solutions for leading Kenyan and international brands across retail, FMCG, real estate, security, & corporate sectors.

Key Contributions

- Managed creative execution for high-profile client portfolios including **Coca-Cola, Quickmart, Junction Mall, SGA,** and other major brands.
- Developed multi-channel campaign assets across social media, paid advertising, influencer marketing, and digital engagement platforms.
- Partnered with strategists, account managers, media buyers, and content teams to deliver integrated marketing campaigns.
- Created visual storytelling frameworks that aligned brand objectives with audience insights and business goals.
- Contributed to campaign optimization through audience-focused creative development and digital content performance improvements.

Business Impact

- Increased brand visibility and audience engagement across multiple sectors.
- Strengthened creative consistency across large-scale national campaigns.
- Built expertise in digital marketing, brand management, and integrated communication strategy.

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Multiple Organizations
Jun 2013 – Dec 2018
Nairobi, Kenya

Graphic Design & Production Specialist
Developed a strong foundation in visual design & production, delivering end-to-end creative solutions across print & branding while ensuring quality, consistency, & effective communication of client & business objectives.

- Built a strong foundation in visual communication, brand execution, and production design across print, corporate, and media environments.
- Designed a wide range of communication materials including brochures, packaging, marketing collateral, signage, and advertising assets, ensuring clarity, consistency, and visual appeal.
- Developed hands-on expertise in end-to-end design processes from concept development and client briefs to final production and delivery.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to translate business and marketing objectives into effective visual solutions across multiple industries.
- Gained practical experience in print production, material selection, and quality control, ensuring high standards in final outputs.
- Strengthened skills in brand interpretation and consistency, working across diverse client needs and organizational contexts.
- Progressively evolved from execution-focused roles into strategic and creative thinking, forming the foundation for advanced marketing and communication expertise.

Key Impact:

- Delivered consistent, high-quality design outputs across multiple sectors including manufacturing, media, and corporate environments.
- Established a solid technical and creative base that enabled transition into high-level strategic communication and campaign design roles.

Thank You for Your Time!